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(54) **PORTULACA PLANT NAMED ‘LAZPRT1609’**

(50) Latin Name: *Portulaca umbraticola* Kunth
Varietal Denomination: **LAZPRT1609**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Portulaca* plant named
‘LAZPRT1609’, characterized by its outwardly spreading to
creeping growth habit; vigorous growth habit; freely branch-
ing habit; freely flowering habit; bright red and yellow-
colored flowers; and excellent garden performance.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical designation: *Portulaca umbraticola* Kunth.
Cultivar denomination: ‘LAZPRT1609’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Portulaca* plant, botanically known as *Portulaca umbra-*
ticola Kunth, commonly known as Wingpod Purslane, and
hereinafter referred to by the name ‘LAZPRT1609’.

The new *Portulaca* plant is a product of a planned
breeding program conducted by the Inventor in Merano,
South Tyrol, Italy. The objective of the breeding program is
to create new vigorous and freely branching *Portulaca*
plants with numerous unique and attractive flowers.

The new *Portulaca* plant is a naturally-occurring branch
mutation of *Portulaca umbraticola* Kunth ‘Duna Red
Flame’, not patented. The new *Portulaca* plant was discov-
ered and selected by the Inventor on a single flowering plant
from within a population of plants of ‘Duna Red Flame’ in
a controlled greenhouse environment in Merano, South
Tyrol, Italy during the spring of 2014.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Portulaca* plant by
terminal cuttings in a controlled greenhouse environment in
Merano, South Tyrol, Italy since the spring of 2014, has
shown that the unique features of this new *Portulaca* plant
are stable and reproduced true to type in successive genera-
tions.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Portulaca* have not been observed under
all possible combinations of environmental conditions and
cultural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with
variations in environmental conditions such as temperature
and light intensity without, however, any variance in geno-
type.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of

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‘LAZPRT1609’. These characteristics in combination dis-
tinguish ‘LAZPRT1609’ as a new and distinct *Portulaca*
plant:

1. Outwardly spreading to creeping growth habit.
2. Vigorous growth habit.
3. Freely branching habit.
4. Freely flowering habit.
5. Bright red and yellow-colored flowers.
6. Excellent garden performance.

Plants of the new *Portulaca* can be compared to plants of
the mutation parent, ‘Duna Red Flame’. Plants of the new
Portulaca differ primarily from plants of ‘Duna Red Flame’
in flower color as plants of ‘Duna Red Flame’ have a less
intense (lower contrast) flower color pattern that is unstable.
In addition, plants of the new *Portulaca* are more freely
branching than plants of ‘Duna Red Flame’.

Plants of the new *Portulaca* can be compared to plants of
Portulaca oleracea ‘Duet Rose Improved’ (U.S. Plant Pat.
No. 16,152), not patented. In side-by-side comparisons,
plants of the new *Portulaca* differ primarily from plants of
‘Duet Rose Improved’ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Portulaca* are more compact than
plants of ‘Duet Rose Improved’.
2. Plants of the new *Portulaca* are more creeping than and
not as upright as plants of ‘Duet Rose Improved’.
3. Plants of the new *Portulaca* have larger flowers than
plants of ‘Duet Rose Improved’.
4. Plants of the new *Portulaca* and ‘Duet Rose Improved’
differ in petal color as plants of ‘Duet Rose Improved’
have yellow-colored petals with purple-colored cen-
ters.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying colored photographs illustrate the
overall appearance of the new *Portulaca* plant showing the
colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored
reproductions of this type. Colors in the photographs may

differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the colors of the new *Portulaca* plant.

The photograph on the first sheet is a side perspective view of a typical flowering plant of 'LAZPRT1609' grown in a container.

The photograph on the second sheet is a close-up view of a typical flowering plant of 'LAZPRT1609'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown in 13-cm containers during the spring and summer in an outdoor nursery in Merano, South Tyrol, Italy and under cultural practices typical of commercial *Portulaca* production. During the production of the plants, day and night temperatures ranged from 13.8° C. to 28.6° C. and light levels ranged from 60 to 70 klux. Plants were four months old when the photographs and the description were taken. In the description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 1995 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Portulaca umbraticola* Kunth 'LAZPRT1609'.

Parentage: Naturally-occurring branch mutation of *Portulaca umbraticola* Kunth 'Duna Red Flame', not patented.

Propagation:

Type.—By terminal cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About 10 days at temperatures about 22° C.

Time to initiate roots, winter.—About 14 days at temperatures about 22° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.—About 24 days at temperatures about 22° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, winter.—About 28 days at temperatures about 15° C.

Root description.—Fine, fibrous; typically pale creamy white in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizers, substrate temperature and age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Spreading to creeping plant habit; vigorous growth habit; relatively rapid growth rate.

Branching habit.—Freely branching habit with lateral branches developing at every node; pinching is not required.

Overall plant height.—About 15 cm.

Plant diameter (area of spread).—About 40 cm.

Lateral branch description:

Length.—About 30 cm to 50 cm.

Diameter.—About 3 mm to 4 mm.

Internode length.—About 2 mm to 20 mm.

Strength.—Moderately strong.

Texture.—Smooth, glabrous; succulent.

Color.—Close to 148A underlain with close to 185B.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Alternate; simple.

Length.—About 1.8 cm to 2.5 cm.

Width.—About 9 mm to 15 mm.

Shape.—Obovate.

Apex.—Initially slightly acute becoming more rounded with development.

Base.—Obtuse.

Margin.—Entire.

Texture, upper and lower surfaces.—Smooth, glabrous; succulent.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper surface: Close to 137A. Developing leaves, lower surface: Close to 148B. Fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Close to 147A; when exposed to full sunlight, margins become closer to 185B in color; venation, close to 147B. Fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 147B; venation, close to 146B.

Petioles.—Length: About 1 mm to 2 mm. Diameter: About 1 mm to 2 mm. Texture, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous; succulent. Color, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 146B.

Flower description:

Flowering habit and arrangement.—Single rotate flowers clustered in terminal cymes; freely flowering habit with potentially about 15 to 30 flowers developing per inflorescence; flowers face mostly upright; flowers sessile.

Fragrance.—None detected.

Natural flowering season.—Plants begin flowering about six to eight weeks after planting; in the garden, plants flower recurrently from mid-spring to mid-autumn in Italy.

Flower longevity.—Flowers last about three days on the plant; flowers not persistent.

Inflorescence diameter.—About 5 cm.

Inflorescence height.—About 2 cm to 3 cm.

Flower diameter.—About 4 cm to 5 cm.

Flower length (height).—About 1.5 cm to 2 cm.

Flower buds.—Length: About 1.2 cm. Diameter: About 5 mm to 7 mm. Shape: Ovoid. Color: Close to 147A to 147B.

Petals.—Quantity and arrangement: Five petals in a single whorl. Length: About 2.2 cm. Width: About 1.8 cm. Shape: Obovate. Apex: Cordate. Base: Truncate. Margin: Entire; towards the apex, slightly serrate. Texture, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Color: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to 9D and close to between 43A and 45B; after anthesis, colors become closer to between 45A and 46A. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to 9D and close to between 43D and 44D; after anthesis, colors become closer to between 45A and 46A.

Sepals.—Quantity and arrangement: Two, opposite. Length: About 1 cm. Width: About 9 mm. Shape: Deltoid. Apex: Acute. Base: Truncate. Margin: Entire. Texture, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous. Texture, lower surface: Smooth, glabrous; leathery. Color, upper surface: Close to 147C. Color, lower surface: Close to 146A to 146B.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: About 50 to 60. Filament length: About 5 mm to 6 mm. Anther shape: Elliptic. Anther length: About 1 mm. Anther color: Close to 25B. Pollen amount: Moderate. Pollen color: Close to 23A. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 1 cm. Style length: About 1 cm.

Fruits.—Length: About 4 mm. Diameter: About 6 mm.
 Texture: Succulent to leathery.
Seeds.—Quantity per flower: About 40. Diameter:
 About 1 mm. Color: Greyish black.
 Garden performance: Plants of the new *Portulaca* have been
 observed to have excellent garden performance and to
 tolerate rain, wind, drought, heat and low temperatures
 about 10° C.

Pathogen & pest resistance: Plants of the new *Portulaca*
 have not been observed to be resistant to pathogens and
 pests common to *Portulaca* plants.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Portulaca* plant named
 'LAZPRT1609' as illustrated and described.

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